

Week 12: Designer

BIG IDEA

The science unit closes with three pieces of evidence pointing to God: fine-tuning, DNA, and design. This week watch two kinds of students: the fired-up arguer, who needs to challenge with truth, love, and respect, and the still-unsure student, who needs you to ask whether the evidence was enough.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- Science is a foundation for understanding our world and does not contradict our faith; fine-tuning, DNA, and design all point to God.
- With design, the conversation between creation and evolution really comes alive, and some students will be fired up to argue with teachers who know more.
- Champion those students rather than telling them not to engage, but make sure they challenge in truth and love, with appropriate respect for teachers.
- For students still not sure, take inventory and ask plainly: was this enough evidence, do you need more, what further questions or clarifications remain?
- The goal of the study is deep personal conviction about what students believe and why, communicated in love and humility, relationally.
- Help eager students be patient about jumping into arguments, because there is so much more to learn.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Which of your students are fired up to argue, and how can you help them challenge others in truth, love, and respect?
2. Which students are still unsure, and have you asked them plainly whether the evidence was enough or what questions remain?
3. How do fine-tuning, DNA, and design each point to God through science?
4. How can you help eager students stay patient when there is still so much more to learn?

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LEADER VIDEO — FULL TRANSCRIPT

The talk from this week's Leader Video, lightly edited for reading. Times point back to that moment in the video.

Wrapping up science

0:05 So we've almost made it through science. We've discovered that science is really a foundation for understanding our world, and that it does not contradict our faith. Well, that's good news. We've also taken a look at three really good pieces of evidence that help us see that God is actually there — that we have evidence for God. We looked at the idea of fine-tuning, we looked at the idea of DNA, and we looked at the idea of design. All of these point to God in some way, shape, or form through the use of science.

The eager student

0:45 Now, I want you to keep in mind two kinds of students this week. The first kind is the student who has all this information and is super fired up, ready to go with the best arguments they have to their teacher — who probably knows more than they do about all these things — especially this week with the idea of design, because this is where the conversation between creation and evolution starts to really come alive.

1:12 It might seem like this is a good idea for them to jump off and start all these arguments and try to win people to Christ. They might try it, and you want to champion that, but at the same time make sure that they do so in truth and love. If they're going to have these conversations, you don't want to tell them not to. It's okay that they can challenge their teachers, and it's okay to challenge their students, but to do so with love, and to do so with the appropriate amount of respect — especially for teachers — as well as engaging in the right kinds of conversations.

The student still unsure

1:47 Now, the other type of student is maybe the one who really is still not sure, or the one who wasn't sure before entering into this conversation. Now would be a really good time to just take a step back and take inventory with that student, and ask them the plain question. Was this enough evidence? Do you need more? What further questions do you have? What clarifications do you need?

Why we do this study

2:13 Now remember the reason why we're doing this study. It's so that our students can have a deep conviction for themselves about what they believe and why they believe it, and also be able to communicate that in love and humility, and do so relationally. So while it might be really exciting to have some eager students ready to get started and to get engaged in conversation, help them be patient, because there is so much more to learn.